

Employing in Turkey

What You Need to Know · Employment Hero HeroForce EOR · July 2026

What does the EOR handle for you?

- **Employment contracts** — compliant contracts under the Turkish Labour Law No. 4857
- **Monthly payroll** — salary payments in TRY, itemised payslips
- **Tax withholding** — cumulative progressive income tax withheld and remitted monthly
- **SGK** — the Social Security Institution contribution stack
- **Leave and termination management** — notice periods, entitlements and kıdem tazminatı (severance) guidance

Employment Conditions

Contracts & Probation

Item	Detail	Legal Basis
Probation period	Maximum 2 months (extendable to 4 by collective agreement)	Labour Law No. 4857
Standard hours	8 hrs/day, 45 hrs/week	Labour Law No. 4857
SGK earnings ceiling (2026)	Raised from 7.5× to 9× the SGK base under Law No. 7566	Law No. 7566 (2026 reform)

Minimum Wage & SGK Contributions (2026)

Measure	Rate	Notes
Minimum wage (gross)	~TRY 33,030/month	+27% from the 2025 net figure; minimum wage earnings are exempt from both income tax and stamp tax
Employer SGK contribution (standard)	20.75% of gross salary (reducible to 16.75%, or 15.75% for manufacturing, with incentives)	Includes the increased MYO (pension) premium rate to 21% total (employer share 12%) from 2026
Minimum wage support subsidy	TRY 1,270/month per eligible minimum-wage employee	Treasury-funded, deducted directly from the SGK premium owed
SGK earnings band	TRY 33,030 (minimum) – TRY 297,270 (maximum) per month	Contributions only calculated within this band

Leave Entitlements

Leave Type	Entitlement	Who Pays	Key Condition
Annual Leave	14–26 days/year (scales with tenure)	Employer	After 1 year of service; Labour Law No. 4857
Maternity Leave	16 weeks (8 before + 8 after birth)	SGK (66.7% of average earnings)	Extendable with unpaid leave up to 6 months
Paternity Leave	5 days	Employer	For the birth of a child

Payroll, Tax & Contributions

Total Cost Example — USD \$3,000 Gross Monthly Salary

Cost Item	Amount (USD)	% of Gross
Gross salary	\$3,000.00	100%
Employer SGK (illustrative, 20.75%)	\$622.50	20.75%
Severance accrual (kıdem tazminatı, 30 days/year ≈ 8.3%)	\$250.00	8.33%
EOR service fee (HeroForce, Tier 2)	\$600.00	20.00%
Estimated total monthly cost	~\$4,472.50	~149.1%

HeroForce EOR service fee shown at USD \$600 per employee per month (Tier 2 pricing), no setup fee. Many employers qualify for a 2–5 point SGK discount (16.75%–18.75% effective), which meaningfully lowers this figure — confirm eligibility with your HeroForce EOR. Severance is shown as a monthly accrual for illustration; it is paid as a lump sum on qualifying termination. Employee deductions (withheld separately) include SGK (14%) and cumulative progressive income tax.

Income Tax (2026)

Turkey applies a cumulative progressive income tax system within the calendar year — the applicable marginal rate rises as the employee's year-to-date taxable income increases, so effective withholding climbs through the year even without a pay rise.

Termination & Separation

Severance Pay (Kıdem Tazminatı)

Turkey's severance system is one of the most distinctive in the region — employers accrue 30 days' gross salary in severance liability per year of service, payable on termination in most circumstances (including redundancy, retirement after minimum service, or certain resignations), with limited exceptions for serious misconduct.

Item	Detail
------	--------

Severance accrual rate	30 days' gross salary per year of service
Severance ceiling	Updated periodically by the Ministry of Treasury and Finance
Notice period	2–8 weeks depending on tenure, under Labour Law No. 4857

★ **HERO TIP**

Kıdem tazminatı is a standing liability that accrues from an employee's very first year — unlike many countries where severance is only a redundancy-specific cost, Turkish employers should treat it as an ongoing balance-sheet obligation for every employee, not a one-off termination expense. Confirm the current severance ceiling with your HeroForce EOR, since it is periodically revised.

Public Holidays 2026

Date	Holiday	Type
1 January	New Year's Day	National
23 April	National Sovereignty and Children's Day	National
1 May	Labour and Solidarity Day	National
19 May	Commemoration of Atatürk, Youth and Sports Day	National
~March/April	Eid al-Fitr (Ramazan Bayramı, 3.5 days)	National (Islamic calendar)
~June	Eid al-Adha (Kurban Bayramı, 4.5 days)	National (Islamic calendar)
15 July	Democracy and National Unity Day	National
30 August	Victory Day	National
29 October	Republic Day	National

Eid al-Fitr and Eid al-Adha follow the Islamic lunar calendar and shift roughly 10–11 days earlier each Gregorian year — confirm exact dates closer to the time.

Ready to hire in Turkey?

HeroForce by Employment Hero is an Employer of Record solution that handles hiring, contracts, compliance and payroll across 180+ countries.

Onboard your first Turkey employee in as little as one to two weeks — HeroForce EOR service fee: **USD \$600** per employee per month, no setup fee (Tier 2).